

ROSE TRAVELEDITED

Travel Radio Australia and we're experiencing Ireland this month and we have Mr. David Murphy who's the operations business and development manager for a great company called Rose Travel and their logo is experience excellence. David welcome to the program. Very good to be here.

Now David you're based in County Kerry in Ireland and if people are coming to Ireland on tours or visits they can actually contact you and tell us about the kind of services that you provide. We provide a full suite of services. It depends what people want to do whether it's just transfers and point-to-point or full suite of transfers for the whole day.

I have the driver as a concierge so basically a representative of Ireland to them. They make a request on the given day, they want something tailored, something adapted to their needs and the driver can make that happen or glaze the office and we'll do our best to make those things come to pass. And tell us about your fleet of vehicles.

I suppose you have a lovely cars and vans to run people around. We've 25 vehicles and starting from SUVs and MPVs, minibuses, midi coaches and full-size coaches. They range from very golf specific vehicles, tables, extra wide chairs, kind of the high-end feel to them to kind of a business class experience where there's still plenty of legroom and comfort to recline, lots of luggage space to keep the cabin clear.

And tell us about some of the regions you cover there and some of your favourite places that you would recommend to people if they are coming to Ireland. It's hard to differentiate in Ireland when it comes to favourites. There's so much to see around every corner whether it's the northwest of Ireland and Donegal and the Sligo coasts right down to the southwest.

We ourselves are going to be a bit biased. We're based in Kerry so we love to see people coming to our home area. Places like Clarney, Dingle, Waterville come to mind.

There's a host of links and parkland golf courses there. Lots of hidden gems. Locals mostly know about them but we can direct people that way as well.

An amazing amount of three, four and five-star hotels and country houses. And then for the days off the golf course there's Sightseeing, there's National Parks. In Dingle there's Ireland's only ocean national park out by Slay Head.

So really folks are spoilt for choice when it comes to touring around Ireland and the southwest. Yes, County Kerry itself is one of the most special places you can possibly go to in Ireland. I actually grew up in Ireland and some of the regions like the Wexford are absolutely gorgeous on the south coast out of Dublin because a lot of people should get out of Dublin too and see the rest of the country.

When you're arriving to Dublin again there's so much to see. You can look north, south or west. If you're heading, you mentioned the Wexford Wicklow direction, the Wicklow Mountains, Glendalough, Powersport, great golf courses down that direction and beaches, rolling landscapes, forests.

So much history, a lot to see. Looking north then towards Belfast, Downpatrick, the Moorings, all that. There's just really lots of choices.

If you don't want to go too far out of Dublin, you want to kind of even come back to the city every day. An hour or two on the road and you're you're right in the middle of the countryside and plenty to see. Now I'm sure you've had some very interesting characters using your service and they must absolutely love it and I'm sure your reviews are fantastic too.

Yeah, we've people from all walks of life and many cultures around the world. The main thing is when they come here it might be their once-in-a-lifetime experience or they might be a seasoned traveller. So either way you're trying to give them something unique and special to them.

They've offered you the opportunity to join them on a trip of a lifetime and for us it's just about making that happen. And I always ask this, can you tell me some of your hidden gems recommendations, maybe a couple of them, where people should get off the beaten track and see something that's really original. Simple things like the Ring of Kerry, small add-on routes where you can take these little coast roads that bring you up mountains or up to smaller little villages that often people on large coach tours won't do.

So if you're a small golf tour or small multi-generational family group and you're looking for something special, take a right-hand turn as you're going along the road, head over to Portmagee. There's a lovely little distillery down there. You can head up the mountaintop and in a small glen that you look down on you can see St. Helens Bay, Skellig Chocolate Factory, Gwaeltacht region, an area of special protection for the Irish language.

And if you look out to the ocean then you see the Skellig Islands which were also featured on Star Wars not too long ago which is another little interesting view you can take from there and again off the beaten track away from the larger groups and something that will bring a special memory to any group. Now when I was a kid we used to drive down from Dublin and hang out on the cliffs and caves in County Wexford and our parents told us to go and when we were little kids to go and look for a little leprechaun who would give us some money but we figured out after a few years that they didn't actually exist and it actually was a very good thing for our parents because they got to relax a little bit. They also took us to a lovely place where you can kiss the Blarney Stone which I did at age 10 and can you tell us a bit about that particular place? Yeah, Irish folklore, myths and legends, yeah there's plenty to hear about and our drivers will certainly regale you with lots of stories about it.

You're talking about Blarney, that's again in the southwest on your way to Cork. Between Cork and Blarney, Blarney Castle there, it's a lovely location. I myself haven't dared to lean backwards over the edge of a castle some 15 meters up and kiss a stone like the whole rest of the crowd before me and behind me but yes many people do love to do that.

As an Irish person I probably don't need the gift of the Blarney Stone. I might have it in my DNA already, maybe. A bit of the Irish language I can say Céimhe Lá Fóillte, Sláinte and Díos Mérida which means God bless you in Gaelic and my father taught me that because both my mother and father were fluent Irish speakers.

Also there's those fabulous little pubs that you can go to where you'll be welcome with open arms in Ireland, mostly in the country areas. They're fascinating where you can really get to the characters there, right? Yeah, that's certainly one thing that Ireland is known for. Any town you go to, any village, they'll have locals pubs.

They'll have pubs that are certainly catering for visitors but you go out to the countryside and the doors open for everyone. Paddy O'Shea's pub in Ventry comes to mind. He's a footballing legend but you go in there the walls are cladded with memories from generations and generations of people that have visited the location.

Yeah, it certainly makes for memorable experiences for anybody that comes to the doors. And when we say football of course there's the Gaelic football which is a bit like us. Well, Australian rules football took a lot of its clues to set itself up with the Gaelic footballers and we had a number of very famous Gaelic footballers.

Jimmy Stines went from Ireland to Melbourne Football Club and did very well and the Gaelic football is huge in Ireland, right? Absolutely massive, yeah. Again, I am from Kerry so Kerry is the kingdom. It's the kingdom not just because we're the closest to heaven but also the home of some of the best footballing talent through the generations.

We boast a majority of Ireland championships and yeah we were very fortunate to hold that title. Okay, it's been great speaking to you. I'm speaking to Mr. David Murphy who's the Operations and Business Development Manager of Rose Travel in Ireland.

How can people find out more about you and the company online, David? You can find us on our website, rosetravel.ie. Look us up on LinkedIn, Instagram, Rose Travel Boss, Facebook, all the other social media outlets. Yes, you've been around since 1994 so you've been providing a fantastic service and thank you very much for being on the program. It's great to be here.

Thank you very much.